



A Vision 2030 Flagship Project



National Drought Management Authority

Kajiado County

Drought Early Warning Bulletin for May 2026

MAY DEW PHASE		Early Warning Phase Classification				
Drought Status: NORMAL  Shughuli za kawaida	LIVELIHOOD ZONE	EW PHASE	TRENDS			
	PASTORAL	NORMAL	STABLE			
	AGRO-PASTORAL	NORMAL	STABLE			
	MIXED FARMING	NORMAL	STABLE			
	COUNTY	NORMAL	STABLE			
Drought Situation & EW Phase Classification Biophysical Indicators ✓ The enhanced and well distributed rainfall during 2026 long rains has enhanced rangeland productivity as evidenced by a vegetation condition index that is above 50. Socio Economic Indicators (Impact Indicators) Production Indicators ✓ Favourable livestock and crop production conditions, evidenced by normal livestock prices, stable milk production, and fair crop conditions, are expected to enhance household food access, availability, and income, and hence support improved food security outcomes. Access indicators ✓ Improved water availability reduced trekking distances to water sources for both households and livestock to below-normal levels. Households were able to save time for economic activities while livestock improved their productivity. Terms of trade favourably supported pastoral households' food purchasing power. ✓ Despite increased milk production, milk consumption remained below normal, which suggest that households are selling a larger share of milk to meet other food and non-food needs. Utilization Indicators ✓ Improved livestock productivity, near average crop yields, and good market performance supported food utilization, with 80% of households consuming a diversified diet.		Biophysical Indicators	Observed Value	Normal Range/LTA		
		Rainfall (% of Normal)		228	80 - 120	
		3-monthly VCI		> 50	35 - 50	
		Pasture condition		Good	Good	
		State of water		Good	Good	
		Production Indicators		Observed LBS	Normal Range	
		Livestock body condition		3 - 4	3 - 5	
		Milk production		2.7 lt	2.5 lt – 3.3 lt	
		Livestock migration		None	None	
		Livestock deaths		None	None	
		Access Indicators		Observed Value	Normal Range	
		Terms of trade (kg of maize for a goat)		108	60 – 117	
		Milk consumption		1.8 lt	1.9 lt - 2.5 lt	
		Distance to water sources	Livestock	3.2 km	3.7 km – 5.5 km	
			Domestic	2.8 km	3.7 km – 5.2 km	
		Cost of water at source (20 litres)		Ksh. 10 – 20	Ksh. 5 – 10	
		Utilization Indicators		Value	Normal Range	
		MUAC		7.7%	6.5% -8.7%	
		CSI		5.5	5.2 – 7.3	
FCS	Acceptable	80.5%				
	Borderline	19.5%				

- Short rains harvest - Short dry spell - Reduced milk yields - Increased HH food stock			- Long rains - Planting/weeding - High calving rate - Milk yields increase			- Long rains harvest - A long dry spell - Land preparation - Increased HH food stocks			- Short rains - Planting - weeding		
Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sept	Oct	Nov	Dec

Seasonal Calendar

1.0 CLIMATIC CONDITIONS

1.1 Rainfall Performance

The 2026 long rains season in Kajiado County was characterized by an early onset and normal cessation. Rainfall began in the second dekad of February and ceased in the second dekad of May. It was fairly distributed both in space and time.

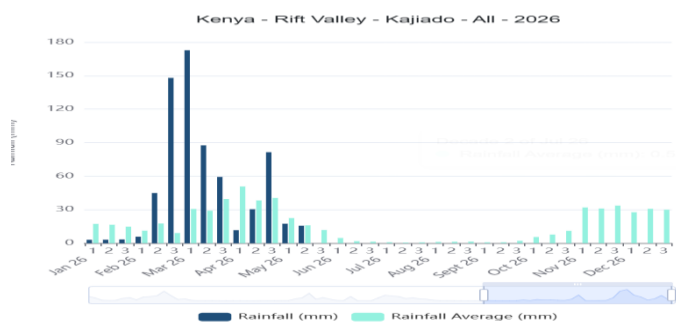


Figure 1. Rainfall performance, Kajiado

Source: <https://dataviz.vam.wfp.org/>

Cumulatively, the county received 669 mm, which is equivalent to 228% of the Long-Term Average (LTA) (Figure 1). This indicates above-normal rainfall conditions during the season.

2.0 IMPACTS ON VEGETATION AND WATER

2.1 Vegetation Condition Index

The County Vegetation Condition Index (VCI) remained above normal for three consecutive months since March because of good rainfall performance of the season. In May, the VCI for the county was above 50 for all the five sub-counties (Figure 2), which indicate above normal vegetation greenness. The ground validation also showed abundant and healthy forage conditions across the county.



Figure 2. 3-months VCI, Kajiado, May 2026

2.2 Pasture and Browse Condition

Pasture and browse conditions are currently good across Kajiado County and are projected to last over the next three months. Nevertheless, the spread of invasive and unpalatable species, particularly *Ipomoea* spp., is limiting livestock access to forage in Kajiado East and Central. Adoption of appropriate control measures, including mechanical removal and strategic fencing of affected areas, is recommended to safeguard rangeland productivity and forage accessibility.

2.3 Water Access and Utilization

2.3.1 Water Sources

Figure 3 shows the three main water sources reported by 21 key informants. Accordingly, pans and dams were the predominant source, cited by 62 percent of respondents as their primary water

source, followed by boreholes and shallow wells. This pattern is typical for the season due to improved surface water availability following the long rains. Other sources reported in May included piped water in Mbirikani, springs in Ewuaso, and river wells in Iloodokilani.

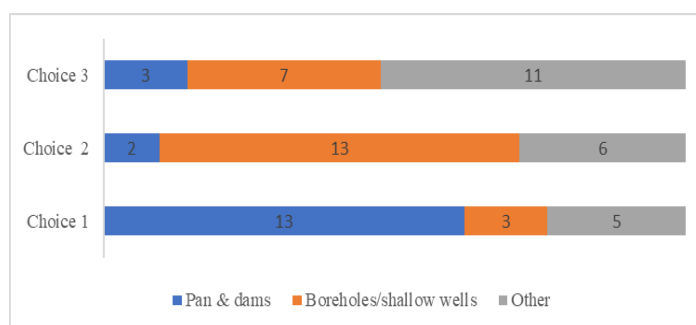


Figure 3. Main water sources, Kajiado, May 2026

2.3.2 Water Access and Utilization by Households

Favourable 2026 long rains improved water availability, reducing the average return distance to

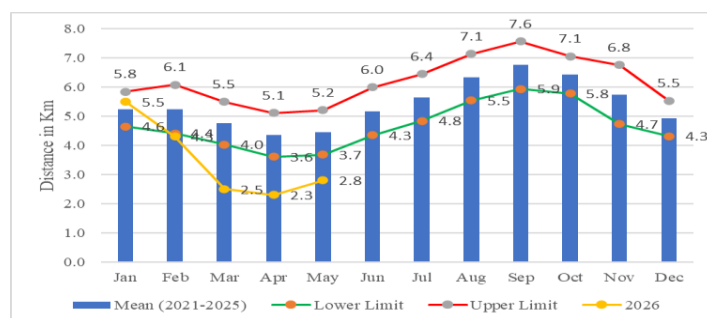


Figure 4. Average return distance to water points from home, Kajiado, 2021-2026

domestic water sources to 2.8 km in May, compared to the five-year average of 4.4 km (Figure 4). The shorter distances eased pressure on water points and increased time available for productive activities. In the pastoral

areas of Mbirikani and Rombo, households travelled about 3.5 km to access water. On average, the household water consumption was 60 litres in pastoral areas, 80 litres in agro-pastoral areas, and 100 litres in mixed farming areas, while water cost remained affordable at Ksh 10 per 20-litre jerrican.

2.3.3 Livestock Access to Water

Livestock trekking distances to water sources remained below the seasonal average during the March–May period (Figure 5), which supported improvement of their body condition and productivity. This in turn supported household nutrition and income. In the pastoral areas of Mbirikani and Rombo, livestock travelled approximately 4 km to access water.

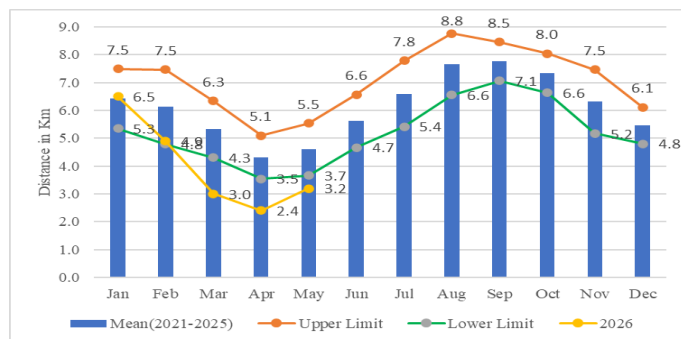


Figure 5. Average return distance from grazing fields to water points, Kajiado, 2021-2026

3.0 PRODUCTION INDICATORS

3.1 Livestock Production

3.1.1 Livestock Body Condition

By May, 85.7 percent of the herd appeared fat and smooth compared to March and April when 28.6 percent and 66.7 percent respectively appeared fat and smooth. This continuous improvement in livestock body condition was because of the availability of good forage and water. There was no significant variation in livestock body condition among livelihoods zones. Good livestock body condition means better productivity, including milk production and prices.

3.1.2 Livestock Mortalities

In May 2026, there were no reports of unusual livestock mortalities due to drought.

3.1.3 Livestock Diseases

Suspected cases of endemic livestock diseases including Contagious Bovine Pleuropneumonia (CBPP), Contagious Caprine Pleuropneumonia (CCPP), Lumpy Skin Disease (LSD), Peste des Petits Ruminants (PPR) and, Foot and Mouth Disease were reported in May. Actions taken included routine surveillance, and individual farmer treatment.

3.1.4 Livestock Migration

No migration was reported in May as livestock remained in their wet season grazing areas.

3.1.5 Milk Production

The average household milk production per day increased from 1.7 litres in January to 2.7 litres

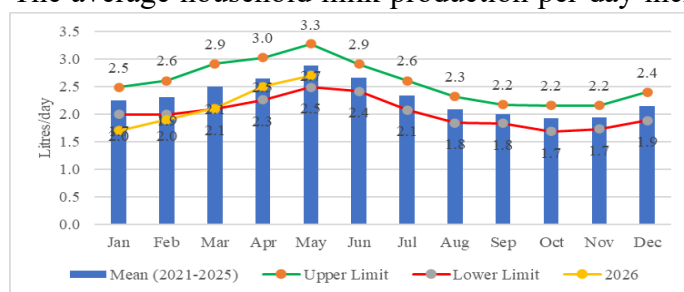


Figure 6. Average household daily milk production, Kajiado, 2021-2026

in May (Figure 6). This continuous increase corresponded to improved livestock body condition due to availability of pasture and water. However, it is likely to stabilize by next month as we enter into the cold and dry season. The current production is within the normal range, which suggests household access to food. In Mbirikani ward, the average household milk production was low at 1.5 litres per day.

3.2 Rain-Fed Crop Production

Maize and bean crops are the main food crops grown in the county. Some farmers had started harvesting beans while maize was in silking stage. Yields for these crops were projected to be

near normal, which would translate to availability of food at household level. Prices of these food commodities would also probably reduce by June because of a good harvest.

4.0 MARKET PERFORMANCE

4.1 Livestock Marketing

The main livestock markets in the county include Isinya, Ilbisil, Kimana, Ewuaso, Rombo, Mashurui, Shompole, and Kiserian. All these markets operated normally in May.

4.1.1 Cattle Prices

The average price of a medium-sized bull remained above the seasonal norm and stable over the past two months, averaging Ksh 46,000. In May, the average price for the past three years stood

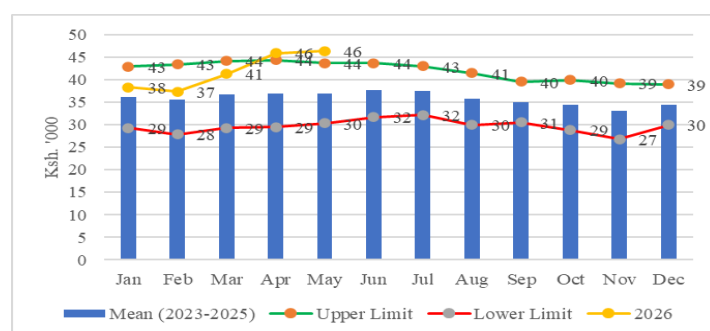


Figure 7. Average Cattle prices, Kajiado, 2023-2026

at Ksh 37,000 (Figure 7). High prices of livestock enhanced household income and purchasing power, improving access to food among pastoral households. Prices ranged from Ksh 34,000 in Dalalekutuk (Kajiado Central) to Ksh 65,000 in Kaputiei

North (Kajiado East), likely reflecting differences in cattle breeds and market dynamics.

4.1.2 Goats Prices

The average price of a medium-sized goat continued to increase, rising from Ksh 7,200 in February to Ksh 8,600 in May. The price for May this year is above the three-year average of Ksh 6,400 (Figure 8). The increase is attributed to improved livestock body conditions following enhanced rainfall and pasture availability. Higher goat prices boosted household income and purchasing power, thereby supporting food access. The lowest price was recorded in Mbirikani at Ksh 7,500, which is probably due to increased livestock supply in nearby markets such as Kimana and Rombo.

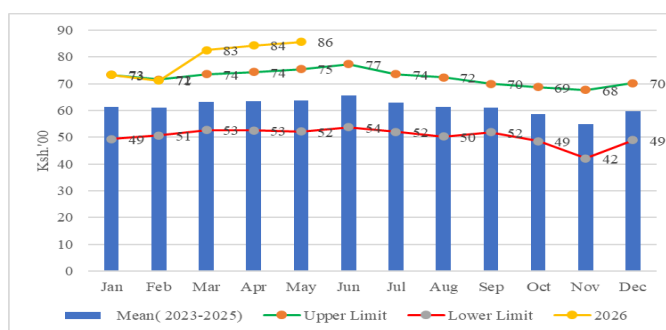


Figure 8. Average goat prices, Kajiado, 2023-2026

4.2 Prices of Cereals and Legumes

4.2.1 Maize Prices

The prices of maize were stable between February and May, and similar to the average prices for the last three years (Figure 9). This stability was probably driven by an expected good harvest during the 2026 long rains season. Maize supply in the market was also stable. Prices of maize were highest in Ewuaso was at Ksh.

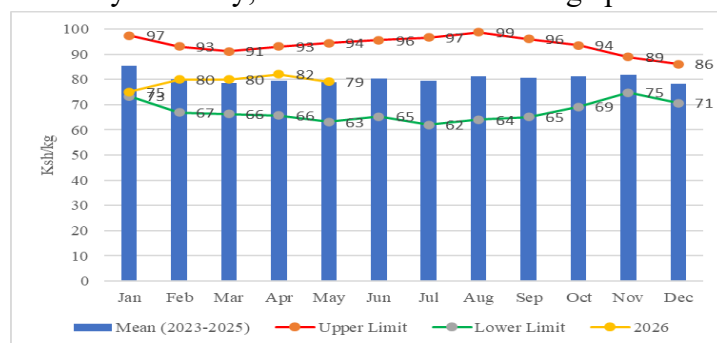


Figure 9. Average price of maize, Kajiado, 2023-2026

120 per kilogram. This part of Pastoral west has poor roads that increases the cost of transportation of goods. Price of maize were likely to drop by June when farmers start harvesting crops such as beans.

4.2.2 Beans Prices

Prices of beans have remained somehow stable at around Ksh. 150 per kilogram since February.

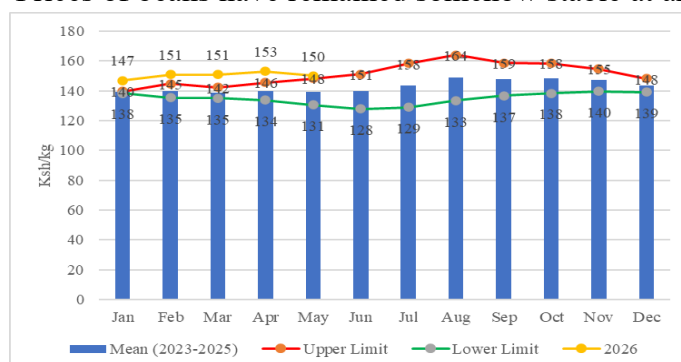


Figure 10. Average price of beans, Kajiado, 2023-2026

This price is above the normal range for this period of the year. For the past three years, the market price for maize in May averaged Ksh. 140 per kilogram (Figure 10). Iloodokilani, which is in Pastoral west, reported the highest price of beans at Ksh. 180 per kilogram because of limited local production and the poor roads that increases the cost of transportation. Prices of beans are expected to drop by June because of the ongoing harvest of beans.

4.3 Milk Prices

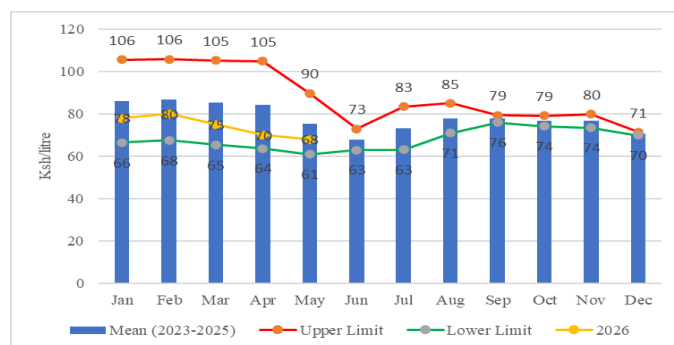


Figure 11. Average price of milk, Kajiado, 2023-2026

The average milk prices declined, but within the normal range, from Ksh. 80 per litre in February to Ksh. 68 per litre in May. The average price of milk in May for the past three years is Ksh 75 (Figure 11). The decline in milk prices would probably be due to an increase in supply

which may have reduced the demand. Mbirikani reported the lowest price of milk of Ksh 60 per litre. Mbirikani ward is homogeneously pastoral and majorly rural, which may have reduced the demand of the commodity from within.

4.4 Terms of Trade

The terms of trade (ToT) increased from 103 kg of maize for a medium-size goat in March to 108 kg of maize for a medium-size goat in May. For the past three years, the average terms of

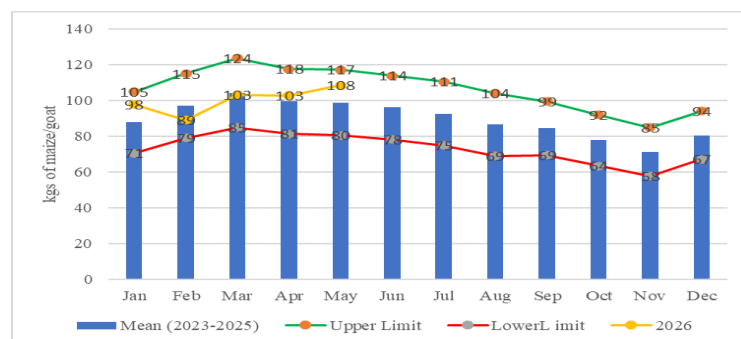


Figure 12. Terms of Trade, Kajiado, 2003-2026

trade in May is Ksh. 99 kg of maize for a medium-size goat (Figure 12). The improvement of ToT was driven by a modest increase in goat prices while maize prices remained stable. Owing to relatively lower maize prices in Rombo, the sub-county

recorded the highest ToT in the county at 168 kg of maize per medium-sized goat, indicating stronger household purchasing power through livestock sales.

5.0 FOOD CONSUMPTION AND NUTRITION STATUS

5.1 Milk Consumption

The daily average household consumption rose from 1.4 litres in March to 1.8 litres in May (Figure 13). This increase in household milk consumption corresponded to an increase in milk production. However, the consumption is below both the normal range and the long term average. In May, for instance, the average milk consumption for the last five years is 1.9 litres per day. Milk consumption below normal suggest that much of the milk is sold, probably to cater for other households' needs such health services and school levies. In this case, milk consumption was likely to stabilize below the normal range by June.

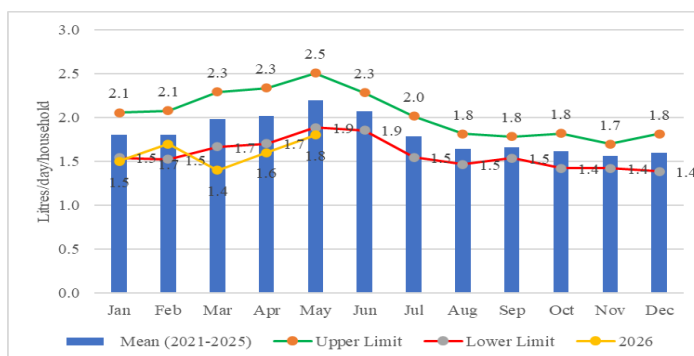


Figure 13. Household milk consumption, Kajiado, 2001-2026

5.2 Food Consumption Score

Figure 14 shows the food consumption score for the county. Accordingly, the proportion of households under poor food consumption band continuously reduced from 5.2 percent in March to less than one percent in May. This improvement means that households were able to consume a more diversified diet by May compared to March.

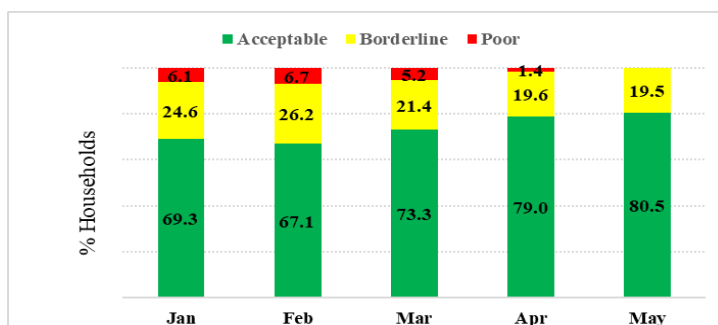


Figure 14. Food consumption score, Kajiado, Jan-May 2026

Food consumption patterns varied greatly within livelihood zones. For instance, in Pastoral west, Ewuaso and Oldonyonyokie, 43 percent and 23 percent of households respectively had moderate dietary diversity with inadequate frequency of nutrient-rich foods.

5.3 Health And Nutrition Status

5.3.1 Nutrition Status of Children Aged 6-59 Months

The proportion of children at risk of malnutrition declined from 9.0 percent in February to 7.7 percent in May (Figure 15). This signifies improved household dietary intake. Mbirikani reported the highest proportion of children at risk of malnutrition of 10.7 percent. In this ward, 40 percent of the households were classified under the borderline food consumption category. Household milk consumption is also low at 1.5 litres a day.

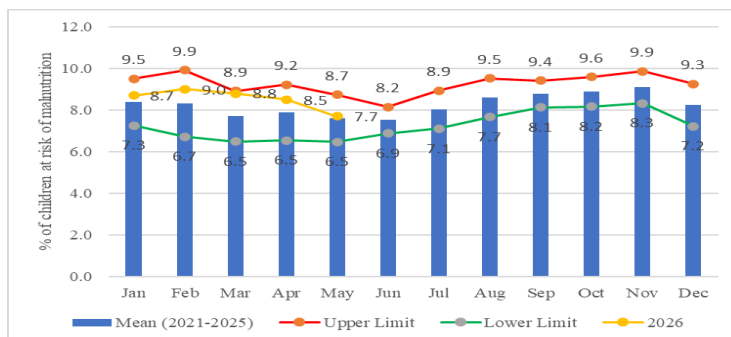


Figure 15. % of children at risk of malnutrition, Kajiado, 2021/6

5.3.2 Health

Disease outbreaks: No major disease outbreaks were reported in May

5.4 Coping Strategies Index

Household coping strategies continue to improve during February-May period (Figure 16). This improvement is associated with better terms of trade and crop performance. Despite relatively higher terms of trade, households in Rombo strained relative more to get food (with coping strategy index of 9.0) despite relatively higher terms of trade reported for the ward. About 40 percent reduced the number meals consumed by adults in order to cope with lack of food.

These patterns reflect underlying economic pressures, with households likely adjusting consumption to preserve limited income from the sale of livestock for other goods and services.

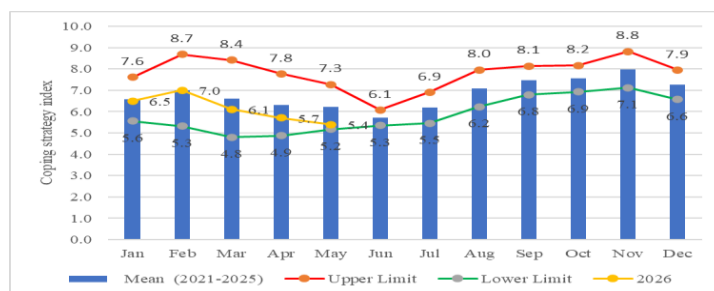


Figure 16. Reduced coping strategy index, Kajiado, 2021-2026

6.0 ONGOING INTERVENTIONS

- ✓ Joint Kenya–Tanzania vaccination exercise launched with supported from the EU-PLACE Project and IGAD–ICPALD, for PPR in goats and sheep to curb transboundary disease spread during the rainy season.
- ✓ Launch of the VITAL 2 initiative supported by County Government and Kenya Veterinary Association and GALVmed. This pilot aims to modernize vaccine distribution through private-sector networks to reach "last-mile" pastoralist farmers.

7.0 DROUGHT PHASE PROGNOSIS, AND ADVISORIES

The county received enhanced and well distributed rainfall during 2026 long rains. This resulted into improvement of key economic sectors namely crop and livestock production. Good crop condition is expected to boost crop yield while livestock productivity mainly their body condition, prices and milk production is either within or above normal range. Market operations are normal and prices of staple food is on decline. The food consumption indicators including food consumption score, indicate improved household dietary intake. All these indicators are likely to remain stable for the next two months. Currently the county is in a stable normal drought phase and was likely to remain so for the next two months.

As we enter into long dry spell, communities and development partners are urged to take advantage of the current drought situation to focus investing on resilience initiatives to reduce drought risks. Some of these initiatives include;

- ✓ Water resource development and management such as construction and rehabilitation of water infrastructures.
- ✓ Rangeland rehabilitation and management such as adopting controlled grazing plans and management of invasive plant species.

- ✓ Enhance uptake of drought early warning information including interpretation and contingency planning
- ✓ Formation and strengthening of community disaster management committees through trainings on drought risk management initiatives such as anticipatory planning and diversification livelihoods

This report was verified by:

County Drought Coordinator; Kajiado County

Name...Hussein Alio.... **Sign...**  **Date...**04/06/2026.....